

Mom's Recipes

a little book of her favorites

♡ ☆ +

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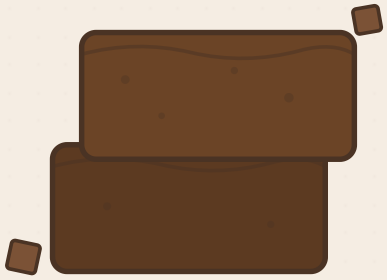
Muesli

Barley and Raisin Water

REFERENCE

Instant Pot Sweet Potatoes

Brownies



SERVES 12

Ingredients

- 300g butter
- 400g chocolate
- 350g sugar
- 5–6 eggs
- 1 tbsp vanilla
- 150g flour
- 90g walnuts
- Pinch of salt

OVEN

180°C · 20–25 min

Method



1. Melt the butter in a saucepan.
2. Add the chocolate and stir until fully combined, then remove from heat.
3. Add the sugar and stir.
4. Transfer the mixture to a bowl and let it cool slightly.
5. Add the eggs and stir.
6. Fold in the flour and a pinch of salt.
7. Fold in the walnuts.
8. Pour the batter into a baking pan.
9. Bake at 180°C for 20–25 minutes.

It's ready when a toothpick comes out almost clean.

Mom's Tip:

You can melt the butter and chocolate together in the microwave in short bursts, stirring each time.

Pancakes

MAKES ABOUT 15

Ingredients

- 2 cups flour, sifted
- 1 tsp baking powder
- Pinch of salt
- 2 eggs, beaten
- 1/4 tsp vanilla essence
- 1 1/2 cups milk
- 1 1/2 cups water

Method

1. Add the eggs, vanilla, milk and water to the flour, salt and baking powder, and beat until smooth.
2. Place the batter in a sealed container and leave to stand overnight before cooking.

Gap:

The source notes only cover mixing the batter — worth asking Mom how she actually cooks these on the pan (heat, timing, when to flip) to fill in the missing step.

Red Velvet Cupcakes

MAKES 12

Ingredients

- 1 1/4 cups all-purpose flour
- 3/4 tsp baking soda
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 2 tbsp unsweetened cocoa powder
- 3/4 cup granulated sugar
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 3/4 cup buttermilk, room temp
- 1/2 cup vegetable oil
- 1 large egg, room temp
- 1/2 tsp white vinegar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 tbsp liquid red food coloring
- Frosting: 1/2 cup unsalted butter, room temp
- Frosting: 4 oz cream cheese, room temp
- Frosting: pinch of salt
- Frosting: 1 tsp vanilla extract

Ingredients *continued*

- Frosting: 2 1/4 cups powdered sugar
- Frosting: 1/2 tbsp milk (more if needed)

OVEN

350°F / 175°C · 18–20 min

Method

1. Preheat the oven and line a muffin pan.
2. Whisk the dry ingredients (flour, cocoa, baking soda, baking powder, sugar, salt) together in one bowl.
3. In a separate bowl whisk the wet ingredients (buttermilk, oil, egg, vinegar, vanilla, food coloring), then combine with the dry mix until smooth.
4. Fill liners 2/3 full, bake 18–20 min until they spring back when pressed. Cool fully before frosting.
5. For the frosting: beat the butter, cream cheese, salt and vanilla until smooth, then beat in the powdered sugar a cup at a time. Loosen with a splash of milk if too thick.

Variation:

Anna Olson's version swaps the food coloring for grated raw beets — more natural, a softer pink-red instead of vivid red. Worth trying as an old-fashioned variant.

Irish Scones

MAKES 12

Ingredients

- 4 2/3 cups (680g) self-raising flour
- 3/4 cup (170g) frozen butter, salted preferred
- 1/2 cup (115g) granulated sugar
- 3 tsp baking powder
- 1 cup (142g) raisins
- 2 large eggs, beaten
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) whole milk

OVEN

425°F / 210°C · 22–26 min

Method

1. Add the flour to a large bowl. Grate the frozen butter straight into it — this is the key trick, cold butter creates flaky pockets as it bakes.
2. Stir in the sugar, baking powder and raisins.
3. Whisk the eggs and milk together, pour into the flour mixture, and stir until a soft dough just comes together.
4. Turn out onto a floured surface, press to about 1 inch thick, cut into rounds with a 3-inch cutter, gather scraps and repeat.
5. Brush tops with egg wash, bake 22–26 minutes until golden brown.
6. Cool slightly, then serve with butter, jam, and/or clotted cream.

Mom's Tip:

Serve with butter, jam, and/or clotted cream.

Spicy Orange Bran Muffins

Ingredients

- 1 1/2 cups natural bran
- 1 3/4 cups buttermilk
- 1 1/4 cups whole wheat flour
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1/2 tsp baking soda
- 2 tsp cinnamon
- 1/2 cup raisins
- 2 tbsp orange zest
- 1 egg
- 1/4 cup brown sugar, loosely packed
- 1/4 cup canola oil
- 2 tbsp molasses
- 2 tbsp honey

OVEN

375°F · ~20 min

Method

1. Combine the bran and buttermilk, let it sit while you prep everything else to soften the bran.
2. In one bowl combine the remaining dry ingredients (flour, baking powder, baking soda, cinnamon, raisins, zest).
3. In another bowl whisk the egg, brown sugar, honey, molasses and oil together.
4. Stir in the bran mixture, then the dry ingredients, just until combined.
5. Bake in a greased muffin tin at 375°F for about 20 minutes. Best served warm.

Orange Muffins (Buttermilk by Sam)

MAKES 12

Ingredients

- 2 large eggs
- 1 cup (200g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (100g) olive oil
- 1/2 tsp baking soda
- Zest of 2 oranges
- 1/2 tsp fine sea salt
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 2 1/4 cups (300g) all-purpose flour
- 1/4 cup (60g) almond flour (or +2 tbsp all-purpose)
- 1/2 cup (120g) plain kefir or buttermilk
- 1/2 cup (120g) fresh orange juice
- Sugar for sprinkling

OVEN

400°F · ~18 min

Method

1. Rub the sugar and orange zest together to release the oils.
2. Beat in the eggs until light and fluffy, then slowly drizzle in the oil.
3. Fold in the flour, vanilla, salt and baking soda, then mix in the kefir and orange juice.
4. Chill the batter 2–4 hours (or overnight) for a better rise.
5. Bake in alternating muffin cups, so they're not touching, at 400°F for about 18 minutes.
6. Dip cooled muffins in glaze, or sprinkle with sugar before baking.

Optional glaze:

1 cup powdered sugar + 3 tbsp orange juice + pinch of salt + dash of vanilla.

Orange Muffins (Pretty. Simple. Sweet.)

MAKES 12

Ingredients

- 3/4 cup (150g) granulated sugar
- 1 tbsp orange zest
- 2 1/8 cups (250g) all-purpose flour, sifted
- 2 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1/4 tsp salt
- 2 large eggs
- 1/3 cup (75g) melted unsalted butter or neutral oil
- 1/4 cup (60ml) sour cream
- 1/4 cup (60ml) whole milk
- 1/2 cup (120ml) fresh orange juice
- 1/2 tsp vanilla extract
- 1 cup optional add-ins (chocolate chips, berries, raisins, nuts)

OVEN

375°F · 15–20 min

Method

1. Toss the sugar and zest together to release the orange oils, then mix in the flour, baking powder and salt.
2. In a separate bowl whisk the eggs, melted butter, sour cream, milk, orange juice and vanilla.
3. Combine the wet mixture into the dry just until mixed, then fold in any add-ins.
4. Bake 15–20 minutes at 375°F until a toothpick comes out clean.
5. Drizzle with glaze once cooled, if using.

Optional glaze:

1/2 cup powdered sugar + 1–2 tbsp orange juice.

Orange & Cinnamon Muffins

Ingredients

- Recipe not yet transcribed — the source site blocked automatic extraction.

Method

1. Copy the recipe in by hand from Viva.co.nz, or ask Mom if she remembers her own version.

TBD:

This page still needs the actual recipe filled in.

Banana Cinnamon Muffins

MAKES 12

Ingredients

- 500ml (280g) cake flour
- 10ml baking powder
- 5ml bicarbonate of soda
- 3ml salt
- 5ml ground cinnamon
- 200ml (160g) sugar
- 5ml grated orange rind (optional)
- 100ml milk or plain yoghurt
- 125ml cooking oil
- 5ml vanilla essence
- 3 large bananas, mashed (about 250g)
- 2 extra-large eggs

OVEN

180°C · 20–25 min

Method

1. Sift the flour, baking powder, bicarb, salt and cinnamon together; stir in the sugar and orange rind.
2. Whisk the eggs, milk, oil and vanilla together.
3. Add the wet mixture to the dry, alternating with the mashed banana, mixing lightly — don't overmix, the batter should stay a bit lumpy.
4. Spoon into greased muffin pans, filling 2/3 full. Bake at 180°C for 20–25 minutes until golden. Cool on a wire rack; serve warm with butter.

Cinnamon Snackers

MAKES ABOUT 20

Ingredients

- 125g butter or margarine, softened
- 80ml (65g) light brown sugar
- 5ml vanilla essence
- 310ml (175g) brown bread flour
- 1ml salt
- 1 extra-large egg
- Topping: 45ml light brown sugar
- Topping: 5ml ground cinnamon

OVEN

180°C · 10–12 min

Method

1. Cream the butter and sugar, beat in the egg and vanilla until light.
2. Sift the flour and salt (add back any bran caught in the sieve) and mix in to form a soft dough.
3. Mix the topping sugar and cinnamon together. Roll the dough into small balls, then roll each ball in the cinnamon-sugar.
4. Place on a greased tray, flatten lightly with a fork, and bake at 180°C for 10–12 minutes. Cool on a wire rack, store in an airtight container.

Banana Loaf

LOAF OR ~12 CUPCAKES

Ingredients

- 2 cups flour
- 3/4 tsp baking powder
- 1 tsp bicarbonate of soda
- 1 cup sugar (quantity uncertain — confirm with Mom)
- 1 tsp vanilla essence
- 1/4 lb (114g) butter
- 4 bananas, mashed well
- 2 eggs, well beaten
- Milk (amount not specified on the card)

OVEN

180°C · 1 hr (loaf) or ~30 min (cupcakes)

Method

1. Cream the butter and sugar, then add the well-beaten eggs.
2. Mix the eggs with a bit of milk.
3. Fold in the flour mixed with the baking powder and bicarb.
4. Add the mashed bananas and bake in a medium oven — 1 hour at 180°C as a loaf, or about 30 minutes as cupcakes.

TBD — the sugar quantity and whether there's a pinch of salt were hard to read on the original card. Double-check with Mom, or she may remember the amounts by heart.

Mom's Tip:

Mom swapped the milk for buttermilk once and said it worked really well — she also used 6 small bananas instead of 4 medium, which made the loaf noticeably higher. (Dated 30/4/2024)

Date Slices

Ingredients

- 1 slab of dates
- Water, enough to mix with the dates
- 250g butter
- Crushed cranberries
- Almonds
- 2 cups flour
- 1/2 cup Pronutro
- Bicarbonate of soda (some)

OVEN

TBD · confirm with Mom

Method

1. Mix the dates with a little water and the butter, then stir in the crushed cranberries.
2. Add the almonds, flour, Pronutro and a little bicarb.
3. Mix and spread into an oven pan, then bake. No time or temp was noted on this one — worth checking with Mom, or test at a standard 180°C and watch for golden edges.

Christmas Cake

SERVES 20–25

Ingredients

- 300g raisins
- 150g diced dried apricots, chopped small
- 75g mixed peel, diced
- 150g glace cherries, chopped
- 180g dates, diced
- 1 cup + 2 tbsp apple juice (or 1/3 brandy + 2/3 apple juice)
- 115g unsalted butter, softened
- 1 1/2 cups dark brown sugar, packed
- 1/2 cup vegetable oil
- 3 tbsp molasses or golden syrup
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/2 tsp allspice
- 1/2 tsp cinnamon
- 1/2 tsp nutmeg
- 3 eggs
- 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 1 2/3 cups plain flour

Ingredients *continued*

- 3/4 cup chopped walnuts (optional)

OVEN

160°C (140°C fan) · ~3 hrs 15 min total

Method

1. Combine the dried fruit and juice/brandy in a microwavable container. Microwave for about 1.5 minutes until hot, stir to coat, then cover and let sit for 1 hour to plump up and cool.
2. Preheat oven to 160°C (140°C fan). Grease and line a deep 21–22cm round cake tin.
3. Beat the butter and sugar until smooth. Beat in the oil and molasses.
4. Add the salt, spices and baking powder, beat to combine. Add the eggs one at a time, beating just until incorporated.
5. Stir in the flour, then fold in the soaked fruit (with any remaining liquid) and the walnuts.
6. Pour into the tin, cover with foil, and bake 2.5 hours. Remove the foil and bake a further 30–45 minutes, until a skewer comes out clean.
7. Cool 20 minutes in the tin, then transfer to a rack to cool completely before serving or decorating.

Storage:

Keeps well — a few months in the fridge, about a year in the freezer.

Vegetable Breyani

Ingredients

- 2 onions
- 1/2 tsp ground whole spice (garam masala), fried briefly in oil
- 1 tsp cumin seeds
- 1 green chili, halved and seeded
- 2 tbsp garlic and ginger paste
- 1 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tsp Kokni (or red leaf masala)
- 1 tsp cumin
- 1 tsp ground coriander
- 1 tsp turmeric
- 1 packet cauliflower and broccoli
- 1/2 packet stir-fry vegetables
- 1 1/2 cups basmati rice
- 1 tbsp ghee
- 1 cinnamon stick
- 2 tsp salt, for the rice
- Turmeric, for the rice
- 1 tin butter beans, drained
- 1 tin lentils, drained

Ingredients *continued*

- 6 small pieces of butter, for steaming

Method

1. Fry the ground whole spice briefly in oil, then add the onions, cumin seeds and halved green chili. Fry until golden, about 10 minutes.
2. Add the garlic and ginger, salt, Kokni, cumin, coriander and turmeric. Add a dash of boiled water to help cook the spices through.
3. Add the cauliflower, broccoli and stir-fry vegetables. Toss with the onion mixture briefly.
4. Add 1/2 cup water and cook for about 20 minutes, until the vegetables are soft.
5. Separately, cook the basmati rice with the ghee, cinnamon stick, 2 tsp salt and a little turmeric.
6. To assemble: layer the vegetable-and-onion mixture, then the drained lentils and butter beans, then the rice on top. Dot the top with the 6 small pieces of butter, close the lid, and steam over very low heat for 20 minutes — same method as the chicken breyani.

Lamb Pilaf

Ingredients

- 3 cups basmati rice
- 3 onions
- 3 green chilies
- 4 tsp garlic and ginger mix
- 100g pure butter
- 1 cinnamon stick
- 2 beef stock cubes, dissolved in 750ml water
- 3 packets stewing lamb
- 1 tbsp Kokni
- 1 tsp cumin
- 1 tsp turmeric
- 1 tsp oregano
- 2 tins lentils
- Salt and pepper, to taste
- Steak and chips spice, for the meat

Method

1. Boil the rice.
2. Sprinkle the lamb with steak and chips spice, then brown the meat and trim off excess fat.
3. Place the lamb in a pressure cooker for 30 minutes.
4. Fry the onions, chilies, garlic-ginger mix, cinnamon stick, and spices (Kokni, cumin, turmeric, oregano) to build the onion mixture, using the beef stock as needed.
5. Add the cooked lamb to the onion mixture, then stir through the lentils.
6. Combine with the boiled rice, season with salt and pepper to taste.

Macaroni and Cheese

Ingredients

- Macaroni (Fattis & Monis)
- 3L water
- 15ml salt
- 3 onions, chopped
- A bunch of celery, finely chopped
- 1 green pepper
- 100g butter
- 1 tsp Nando's mild sauce
- 300g mature cheddar cheese, coarsely grated
- 200g breadcrumbs
- 1 tsp each: origanum, paprika, mustard
- 6 eggs
- 2 tsp salt
- 1.5L milk

OVEN

180°C · 1 hr

Method

1. Boil the macaroni in the water with the 15ml salt until done.
2. In a pan, cook the onions, celery and green pepper in the 100g butter until soft and golden. Stir in the Nando's mild sauce.
3. Mix the breadcrumbs with the origanum, paprika and mustard.
4. In an oven dish, combine the cooked macaroni, breadcrumbs, grated cheese and the onion mixture.
5. Whisk the eggs with the 2 tsp salt and the milk, then pour over everything in the dish.
6. Bake at 180°C for 1 hour. Cool before serving.

Chicken Pilaf

Ingredients

- 1 cup basmati rice
- 2 onions
- 1 green chili
- 2 tsp garlic and ginger mix
- 50g pure butter
- 1 cinnamon stick
- 1 tsp chicken stock, dissolved in 750ml water
- 1kg chicken
- 1 tbsp Kokni or chicken masala
- 1 tsp cumin
- 1 tsp turmeric
- 1 tsp oregano
- 1 tin lentils
- Salt and pepper, to taste
- Chicken spice, for the meat

OVEN

180°C · 30 min, foil-covered

Method

1. Boil the rice.
2. Sprinkle the chicken with chicken spice, then brown it and trim off excess fat.
3. Melt the butter in a pot, add diced onions, chili, garlic and ginger, and cook until soft and golden.
4. Stir in the masala/Kokni, oregano, turmeric and cumin. Add a splash of boiling water and cook for about a minute to bring out the spices.
5. Add the browned chicken, stir, season with salt and pepper, then add the stock. Cook for about 5 minutes.
6. Stir in the lentils.
7. Mix the chicken mixture into the boiled rice. Cover the dish with foil and bake at 180°C for 30 minutes.

Chicken and Creamed Corn Soup

Ingredients

- 1 red onion, diced
- 3 cloves garlic, mashed
- Chili flakes, a sprinkle
- 4 chicken breasts, cubed
- Chicken spice, Cajun spice, oregano, salt and pepper, to season
- 2 tbsp butter
- 1 tsp flour
- 2 cups half and half (1 cup cream + 1 cup milk)
- Cayenne pepper, salt (generously) and pepper, to taste
- 1 bag frozen corn
- 3 cups boiling water
- Cream of corn "cuppa soup" sachets, sifted
- 2 tsp chicken stock
- Fresh parsley, to finish

Method

1. In a small pot, cook the diced red onion, mashed garlic and chili flakes.
2. Season the cubed chicken with chicken spice, Cajun spice, oregano, salt and pepper. Cook until browned, then let it rest with the lid on.
3. Separately, make the creamed corn: melt the butter, stir in the flour, then add the half-and-half. Season with cayenne pepper, salt and pepper. Add the frozen corn and bring to a boil, about 10 minutes, then simmer for 15 minutes.
4. For the stock: combine the boiling water with the sifted cream-of-corn soup sachet and the chicken stock.
5. Combine the chicken, creamed corn and stock together in one pot, and boil for a few minutes. Finish with fresh parsley.

Stovetop Popcorn

ABOUT 10 CUPS

Ingredients

- 2 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil or coconut oil
- 1/2 cup popcorn kernels, divided
- Salt, to taste

Method

1. Heat the oil with 2 kernels in a large, heavy-bottomed pot over medium heat, lid on. Wait for those 2 to pop — that's your signal the oil's ready.
2. Remove from heat, add the remaining kernels, cover, shimmy to spread evenly, and let sit 60 seconds off the heat.
3. Return to medium heat, shimmying occasionally. Once popping starts, crack the lid slightly to let steam escape.
4. Cook until pops slow to a few seconds apart. Tip into a bowl, salt to taste, serve right away.

Safety tip:

Don't crank the heat too high — if you ever see real smoke, turn off the heat and leave the lid on rather than moving the pot.

Green Smoothie

Ingredients

- 2 bananas
- 2 apples, peeled and cored
- 2 brown pears
- Juice of 2 oranges
- 2–4 dessert spoons yoghurt
- Some honey, to taste

Method

1. No method given — blend everything together.

Peanut Butter Cocoa Smoothie

Ingredients

- Peanut butter
- Cocoa nibs
- Dates
- Banana
- Coconut milk

Method

1. No exact quantities given — blend to taste and consistency.

Banana Peanut Butter Smoothie

Ingredients

- 1/2 cup milk
- 1/2 cup full cream yoghurt
- 3 ice blocks
- 1 tsp peanut butter
- 1 banana

Method

1. No method given — blend everything together.

Muesli

Ingredients

- Almonds
- Raw cocoa
- 100g coconut shavings
- Pumpkin seeds
- Sunflower seeds
- Cocoa powder
- Coconut oil

OVEN

150°C · stirring regularly until toasted

Method

1. Mix the almonds, raw cocoa, coconut shavings, pumpkin seeds and sunflower seeds in a bowl.
2. Add the cocoa powder and stir in the coconut oil to coat.
3. Spread out and bake at 150°C, stirring regularly so it toasts evenly.

Barley and Raisin Water

Ingredients

- 2 tbsp pearl barley
- A handful of raisins

Method

1. Soak the barley overnight, rinse, then soak again.
2. Boil the barley, adding the raisins towards the end of the process.

Instant Pot Sweet Potatoes

Ingredients

- Whole sweet potatoes, any size

Method

1. Pressure-cook whole sweet potatoes, then allow a 10 minute natural release. Timing depends on size:
2. Small (under 2 in wide): 15 minutes.
3. Medium (2–3 in wide): 30 minutes.
4. Large (3–4 in wide): 60 minutes.

Note:

This is Mom's own timing reference, not a full recipe.

Her recipes were made with love.

Her life was lived with even more.

A love that will forever remain at our table.



Created with love by Aidan & Shanny